SHEIKH ATIYA ISLAM

Department of Economics, Pennsylvania State University
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Education

Pennsylvania State University Ph.D. in Economics — Expected 2027
Primary fields: Industrial Organization, Health Economics
Dissertation Committee: **Conor Ryan (Main Adviser)**, Joris Pinkse, Mark Roberts

University of Dhaka M.S.S. in Economics — 2019
GPA: 3.91/4.00

University of Dhaka B.S.S. in Economics — 2018
GPA: 3.99/4.00

Research Fields

Primary Fields: Industrial Organization, Health Economics

Secondary Fields: Applied Microeconomics, Environmental & Energy Economics

Job Market Paper

"Physicians' Location Choice and Access to Healthcare: The Case of Dobbs" *Job Market Paper*

This paper studies how practice location-level regulation changes the geographic sorting of physicians across local markets. I use the variation in state-level measures of the legal environment resulting from the SCOTUS landmark decision to repeal the federal right to abortion in *Dobbs v. Jackson Women's Health Organization* and combine it with longitudinal physician practice-location data to estimate a discrete-choice model of OB/GYN physician location. The analysis separates the decision to move from the choice of destination, allowing the legal environment to affect where physicians sort even when aggregate mobility responds weakly. I then use the estimated choice model to quantify how alternative legal environments reallocate physicians across locations and change access to obstetric and gynecologic care.

Research in Progress

"Role of Information on Physicians' Prescription Choice: Evidence from FDA Accelerated Approval"

This project studies how physicians adjust prescribing when the FDA Accelerated Approval program changes the information available about a drug's clinical value, with a focus on how information frictions shape treatment choice in pharmaceutical markets.

"Energy Transition in the Context of the First Market-Based Cap-and-Trade Program in the U.S." *(with Emily Pakhtigian)*

This project examines how electric-generating plants adjust operation, generation, and fuel use in response to carbon-pricing incentives under the Regional Greenhouse Gas Initiative.

Teaching Experience

Pennsylvania State University — Instructor of Record
ECON 306: Introduction to Econometrics
ECON 104: Introductory Macroeconomic Analysis

Pennsylvania State University — Teaching Assistant
ECON 501: Econometrics; ECON 445: Health Economics; ECON 423: Economics of Public Expenditure; ECON 422: Applied Monetary Theory and Monetary History; ECON 304: Intermediate Macroeconomic Analysis;
ECON 104: Introductory Macroeconomic Analysis; ECON 102: Introductory Microeconomic Analysis

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Emily Pakhtigian, Penn State School of Public Policy
Research on electricity markets, environmental regulation, and firm responses to cap-and-trade policy.

Research Assistant to Conor Ryan, Penn State Department of Economics
Research on healthcare and pharmaceutical markets, physician decision-making, and applied microeconomics.

Research Consultant, East West University, Dhaka, Bangladesh
Tobacco research project: survey analysis, metadata analysis, and research-report preparation.

Academic Service & Mentoring

Graduate Assistant, Undergraduate Research and Fellowships Mentoring
Pennsylvania State University 2026–27
Support undergraduate research engagement, fellowship advising, and related programming.

Selected Presentations

- Pennsylvania State University, 2025
  "Energy Transition in the Context of the First Market-Based Cap-and-Trade Program in the U.S."
- Pennsylvania State University, 2024
  "Physicians' Location Choice and Access to Healthcare: The Case of Dobbs"
- Pennsylvania State University, 2023
  "Role of Information on Physicians' Prescription Choice: Case of FDA Accelerated Approval"
- 16th Asian Business Research Conference, Dhaka, 2019 — "Tourism and SDGs in Bangladesh"
- YSI Asia Convening, Hanoi, 2019
  "The Impact of Foreign Remittances on Income Inequality: Bangladesh Case"
- 15th South Asian Economics Students' Meet, Colombo, 2019
  "The Impact of Foreign Remittances on Income Inequality: Bangladesh Case"

Fellowships & Awards

- Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies, 2026
- Dean's List, 2018
- Prime Minister's Gold Medal, University of Dhaka, 2018
- Professor Dr. Nasrin Khondoker Memorial Gold Medal, University of Dhaka, 2018 — highest CGPA in the College of Social Sciences
- Shah A. M. S. Kibria Prize, 2018
- Shaheed Shafi Imam (Rumi) Memorial Scholarship, 2018
- Governor Scholarship, Department of Economics, University of Dhaka — outstanding academic performance

Computing: R, Julia, STATA

Languages: Bangla (native), English (fluent), French (B1)

References

Conor Ryan	**Joris Pinkse**	**Mark Roberts**
Strumpf Early Career Professor of Economics	Professor of Economics	Professor Emeritus of Economics
Pennsylvania State University	Pennsylvania State University	Pennsylvania State University
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